

3.8 Design and Traffic Management

Addition

The need for a detour route should be considered for all road closures. The following additional guidance is provided for determining the need for and signing detours (also see Section 3.8.1 for information on designing and signing a detour).

Detour routes may not be required for short road closures of local streets in a simple grid network or for side road closures of minor roads when an alternative route is available and obvious. When closing a road and determining the need for a detour route, the TMD must consider several factors including:

1. The need for a detour is primarily dependent on:
 - a. the type of road being closed
 - b. the types of road users impacted by the closure, and
 - c. the surrounding road network (availability and suitability of a detour route).
2. Other factors include consideration of the following:
 - a. the length of the closure (both in terms of time frame and the overall length of the road section being closed)
 - b. the length or complexity of any potential detour routes
 - c. the surrounding road network and the ease to which the typical road user may locate a suitable alternative route without the need to fully or partially sign a detour route
 - d. the risks versus benefits associated with installing the signs for a detour route, and
 - e. the potential confusion for road users who encounter the signs for a detour route but are not impacted by or aware of the road closure requiring a detour (especially relevant when closing a local street and using a higher order road as part of the detour route).

In addition to the above, detour routes should be provided when closing major links such as tunnels or bridges or arterial roads, and the following options for detour routes and signs for these links should be considered:

3. Fully sign the closure and the various detour routes based on likely destinations to be sought by road users.
4. Fully sign the closure and allow road users to use the existing current signage if adequate to direct them to their chosen destinations.